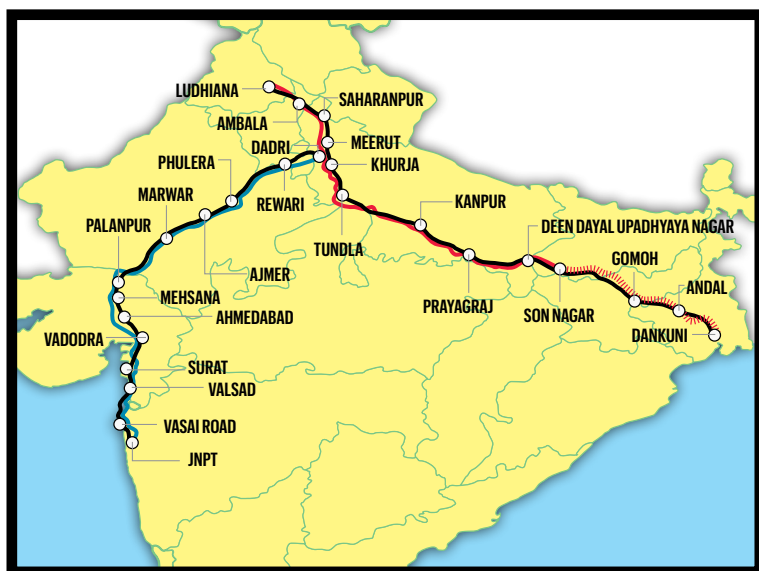
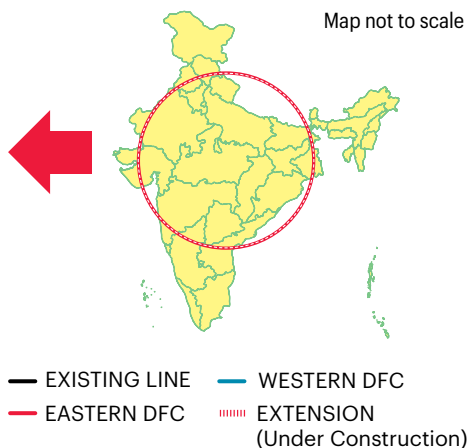




EAST MEETS WEST

The DFCs connect the eastern coalfields with northern power plants, and western ports with northern factories



DFC IN NUMBERS

	Length (km)	Route	Traffic Type	Funding (₹ crore)	FUNDER
Western DFC	1,506	Dadri to Mumbai	Container goods/ EXIM/automobile	72,800	JICA* & Railways
Eastern DFC	1,337	Ludhiana to Son Nagar	Coal/fertilisers	51,200	World Bank & Railways
Total	2,843	SOURCE DFCCIL; *JAPAN INTERNATIONAL COOPERATION AGENCY			

11,000
HECTARES ACQUIRED FOR THE PROJECT

535
MAJOR BRIDGES

304
ROAD OVER BRIDGES

4,643
MINOR BRIDGES

53
OVER RAIL FLYOVERS

557
ROAD UNDER BRIDGES

dian Railways PSU DFCCIL but picked up pace after the NDA government came to power in 2014—is expected to lead to a shift in the movement of freight. From 2000-01, the share of freight traffic had shifted decisively in favour of road—from 63% in 1990-91, the share of rail dipped to a low of 26% by 2021-22, per the DFCCIL, with a corresponding jump in the road share from 37% in 1990-91 to 74% in 2021-22.

Now, the Railways is looking to increase the share of rail in freight loading to 45% by 2050. To make that

happen, it has pumped ₹1.24 lakh crore into the two DFCs, which are likely to be fully commissioned by the end of 2024.

ON THE DFC, freight trains run at a maximum speed of 100 kmph, against 75 kmph on the Indian Railways network, where passenger trains get priority. More importantly, the average speed is 45 kmph on both the DFCs, almost double the